

Chapter 149-2

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When Gu Yixue returned to the private room, she had an extra suit jacket on. Her hair was also down now—no longer the high ponytail from before, but all loosened, long enough to cover her shoulder blades.

But her expression was still the same as before, a smile carrying a hint of coldness.

While waiting for everyone to finish eating, she lit a cigarette, stood by the window to finish smoking, then returned to the table and asked the two young girls, Qi Tang and Tang Zui: "Are you full?"

The two young girls nodded: "We're full."

Then the group went downstairs, and Gu Yixue went to the counter to pay.

While going downstairs, Liang Shi noticed a woman in a white shirt on the first floor whose gaze swept toward them.

The woman's pupils were very beautiful, but those eyes were too sharp, emanating a powerful pressure.

Sitting across from her was a girl wearing a purple sweater and a tulle skirt, who looked gentle and serene—forming a stark contrast with her.

Liang Shi only glanced casually before quickly looking away.

Gu Yixue finished paying, and then they heard someone call out: "Xiao Xue."

The group all turned around at once, looking toward the source of the voice.

Liang Shi saw the girl in the purple sweater walking toward them, with the woman in the white shirt following closely behind.

Gu Yixue saw the woman in purple and nodded with a smile: "Xiaoxiao-jie."

Distant yet polite.

"It really is you." Kong Xiaoxiao smiled and patted her shoulder. "I thought it looked like you... Hey, isn't that Fenghe's jacket you're wearing? Looks like you two already ran into each other."

Gu Yixue glanced at Shen Fenghe. Shen Fenghe was looking down and poking at her phone, not making eye contact with her at all.

Gu Yixue said: "Mm, we ran into each other in the restroom just now. Fenghe-jie saw I was too cold, so she lent me her jacket."

"I see." Kong Xiaoxiao said with feeling. "It's been years since we last met."

"I've been abroad for several years." Gu Yixue said. "I just came back not long ago. I haven't really been back much."

"Then we should get together often from now on. I've seen your films—you really live up to being Gu Yixue, you really know how to shoot." Kong Xiaoxiao praised. "Last time when Fenghe and I watched together, she even praised you."

Shen Fenghe finished what she was doing. Hearing this, she frowned and glanced at her friend: "When did we watch it?"

But Gu Yixue smiled and said: "Thank you for Fenghe-jie's praise."

"I praised you too. How come you're not thanking me?" Kong Xiaoxiao said, as if seeking a reward.

Gu Yixue paused briefly: "Thank you too, Xiaoxiao-jie."

As she spoke, Gu Yixue went to pay for their table's bill, but Kong Xiaoxiao stopped her: "How can I let you, a little sister, pay? I'll get it."

"It's fine." Gu Yixue had already finished paying. Then she glanced at Shen Fenghe: "Consider it my treat. Next time you and Fenghe-jie can treat me back."

When she said "Fenghe-jie," there was somehow a hint of something suggestive in it.

But Shen Fenghe remained expressionless from start to finish, standing there like a cardboard cutout.

Kong Xiaoxiao exchanged a few more pleasantries with Gu Yixue before the group finally left.

After they left, Kong Xiaoxiao and Shen Fenghe also grabbed their things and headed out. "Ah, time really flies. Back then Gu Yixue was just a little bean sprout, and in the blink of an eye she's become an internationally renowned director. Isn't she younger than Shen Hui?"

"No." Shen Fenghe said. "She's a year older than A-Hui."

"So she's younger than us by..." Kong Xiaoxiao hesitated for a few seconds before calculating. "Six years."

"Mm." Shen Fenghe nodded and put on her coat.

Kong Xiaoxiao sighed: "I still remember when she used to cry from being bullied by Gu Chunmian."

"That was so long ago." Shen Fenghe said. "You still remember."

"What? I can't talk about it just because Gu Chunmian is your fiancée?" Kong Xiaoxiao wrapped her scarf around herself. The two of them came out of the restaurant and stood on the street. Kong Xiaoxiao crossed her arms and watched the traffic, still reminiscing about childhood with Shen Fenghe. "If you ask me, Gu Chunmian has been a bastard since she was little. Back then she locked Gu Yixue in a closet for four days and nearly suffocated her to death. If you hadn't found her, Gu Yixue would have been a corpse."

"Oh right." Kong Xiaoxiao stamped her feet and breathed into her palms. "Has Gu Chunmian broken things off with that woman yet?"

"No." Shen Fenghe replied coldly.

Kong Xiaoxiao: "....."

"So are you two still getting married or not?" Kong Xiaoxiao asked.

Shen Fenghe paused, then answered: "Yes."

Kong Xiaoxiao: "....."

"Then why don't you step in and make Gu Chunmian break it off with that woman?" Kong Xiaoxiao understood matters of marriage alliances between prominent families, but she particularly looked down on this kind of behavior—already engaged yet still messing around outside. "Are you really going to let Gu Chunmian graze sheep on your head?"¹

Hearing this, Shen Fenghe furrowed her brow and walked toward the car. She happened to see Gu Yixue seeing off the young girls from her crew.

She put the girls into a taxi, paid for them, and even leaned into the car window to remind the driver to drive slowly.

She was quite thoughtful.

Shen Fenghe got into the car, and Kong Xiaoxiao followed.

From the rearview mirror, she could just see Gu Yixue standing under a tree chatting with a woman.

It was the one from inside the restaurant earlier.

Gu Yixue was dressed lightly, just wearing a wool coat over her suit jacket. The wind blew her clothes fluttering in the air, along with her hair.

She took out a cigarette and lit it, chatting with a faint, detached smile.

The scarlet cigarette tip flickered in the air.

Kong Xiaoxiao glanced over: "I heard the entertainment industry is pretty chaotic. I wonder if our Xiao Xue has picked up any bad habits?"

Shen Fenghe lowered her gaze and thought to herself: "She definitely has."

But in front of her, why was she still the same child who never grew up?

Always crying.

Kong Xiaoxiao sighed before remembering to continue asking Shen Fenghe: "You and Gu Chunmian are both not young anymore. If you're going to get married, shouldn't you hurry? Any later and she might be marrying you while pregnant with that woman's child. What? Are you going to raise someone else's kid?"

Shen Fenghe pressed her lips together and said flatly: "I'm not an idiot."

Kong Xiaoxiao: "....."

Shen Fenghe was feeling frustrated. She found a pack of cigarettes in the car, put one in her mouth, and lit it.

Her gaze fixed on the person standing under the tree, chatting and smoking. Her voice was very cold: "If I step in and break them up, won't Gu Chunmian raise hell with me?"

Kong Xiaoxiao: "Then what do you do?"

Shen Fenghe exhaled a ring of smoke: "Haven't figured it out yet. Let her family..."

She paused mid-sentence. The Gu family had long known that Gu Chunmian had a white moonlight, and had even had an abortion for the sake of that white moonlight.

Right now she still had the temporary mark² of her white moonlight on her body.

When it came time to marry Shen Fenghe, she would have to wash away the temporary mark.

But Gu Chunmian was favored in the Gu family, so no one in the family did anything about it. That's why she had been allowed to drag out this marriage for so many years.

It was only because her own father didn't concern himself with worldly matters, and her mother didn't interact much with the other ladies in their circle, that they didn't know about Gu Chunmian's messy affairs.

She had thought about breaking off the engagement before, but that happened to coincide with A-Hui's situation.

She had flown abroad overnight to bring A-Hui back. Seeing how low the mood was at home, she never brought it up again.

Now she couldn't be bothered anymore. She could afford to wait it out.

After all, she wasn't the one being tormented by this marriage.

Footnotes:

¹ "Graze sheep on your head" (在你腦袋上放羊): A Chinese idiom/slang meaning to be cuckolded or cheated on. The imagery suggests someone is treating your head like an open pasture—doing whatever they want with no regard for you.

² Temporary mark (臨時標記): In ABO dynamics, this refers to a marking that is not permanent, usually created during intimate moments. Unlike a permanent mark which bonds two people for life, a temporary mark fades over time and can be "washed away" or removed.